Futures Trading Combine: Master Briefing & Specifications

Note on Crypto "Mini" Tickers: CME does not offer an intermediate "Mini" tier for crypto futures. The market consists of the **Standard / Full-Size contracts (BTC and ETH)** and the **Micro contracts (MBT and MET)**. Both standard contracts are included below to provide the complete trading hierarchy.

1. Equity Index Futures (U.S. & Global)

E-mini S&P 500 (ES)

Offers steady liquidity, tight spreads, and clean two-to-three-minute decision zones; widely considered the institutional benchmark for intraday technical levels.

- **Ticks per point:** 4 ticks (0.25 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $12.50
- **Cost per point:** $50.00
- **Cost / Contract Value:** $50 × S&P 500 Index (e.g., at 5,600 = $280,000)

Micro E-mini S&P 500 (MES)

Allows for precision sizing discipline, scaling in/out, and strict risk management during combine drawdown rules at 1/10th the risk of the ES.

- **Ticks per point:** 4 ticks (0.25 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $1.25
- **Cost per point:** $5.00
- **Cost / Contract Value:** $5 × S&P 500 Index (e.g., at 5,600 = $28,000)

E-mini Nasdaq 100 (NQ)

High momentum, wide ranges, and aggressive velocity; requires tighter timing filters, wider stops, and disciplined execution due to frequent liquidity sweeps and volatility spikes.

- **Ticks per point:** 4 ticks (0.25 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $5.00
- **Cost per point:** $20.00
- **Cost / Contract Value:** $20 × Nasdaq 100 Index (e.g., at 19,500 = $390,000)

Micro E-mini Nasdaq 100 (MNQ)

Provides direct access to Nasdaq momentum and trend expansions while keeping tick-risk small enough to survive volatile opening drives and combine drawdown limits.

- **Ticks per point:** 4 ticks (0.25 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $0.50
- **Cost per point:** $2.00
- **Cost / Contract Value:** $2 × Nasdaq 100 Index (e.g., at 19,500 = $39,000)

E-mini Russell 2000 (RTY)

Small-cap index known for distinct rotational flow and strong directional trend days, though prone to erratic intraday chop during low-volume sessions.

- **Ticks per point:** 10 ticks (0.10 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $5.00
- **Cost per point:** $50.00
- **Cost / Contract Value:** $50 × Russell 2000 Index (e.g., at 2,200 = $110,000)

Micro E-mini Russell 2000 (M2K)

Ideal for trading small-cap breakout strategies and range rotation without exposing combine accounts to full RTY slippage and point costs.

- **Ticks per point:** 10 ticks (0.10 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $0.50
- **Cost per point:** $5.00
- **Cost / Contract Value:** $5 × Russell 2000 Index (e.g., at 2,200 = $11,000)

E-mini Dow Jones (YM)

Characterized by steady trends and heavier price weighting on blue-chip industrials; often calmer than NQ, making it well-suited for traders with conservative daily loss limits.

- **Ticks per point:** 1 tick (1.00 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $5.00
- **Cost per point:** $5.00
- **Cost / Contract Value:** $5 × Dow Jones Index (e.g., at 41,000 = $205,000)

Micro E-mini Dow Jones (MYM)

A smooth, predictable instrument for learning order flow and managing risk tick-by-tick on the Dow with ultra-low capital commitment.

- **Ticks per point:** 1 tick (1.00 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $0.50
- **Cost per point:** $0.50
- **Cost / Contract Value:** $0.50 × Dow Jones Index (e.g., at 41,000 = $20,500)

Nikkei 225 USD (NKD)

Offers prime liquidity during the Asian and early European sessions; excellent for overnight combine trading driven by global macro flows and yen dynamics.

- **Ticks per point:** 0.2 ticks (5.00 points per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $25.00
- **Cost per point:** $5.00

- **Cost / Contract Value:** $5 × Nikkei 225 Index (e.g., at 38,000 = $190,000)

Micro Nikkei 225 USD (MNK)

Enables precise position sizing for overnight Asian session trends without the large $25 per tick liability of the full NKD.

- **Ticks per point:** 0.2 ticks (5.00 points per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $2.50
- **Cost per point:** $0.50
- **Cost / Contract Value:** $0.50 × Nikkei 225 Index (e.g., at 38,000 = $19,000)

2. Metals & Commodities

Gold Futures (GC)

A primary safe-haven asset featuring large intraday momentum moves during economic data releases (CPI, FOMC), respecting clear supply/demand support and resistance zones.

- **Ticks per point:** 10 ticks (0.10 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $10.00
- **Cost per point:** $100.00
- **Cost / Contract Value:** 100 oz × Gold Price (e.g., at $2,500 = $250,000)

Micro Gold Futures (MGC)

Highly popular for combine evaluation phases, allowing traders to capture major multi-dollar gold breakout trends without exceeding strict daily max loss rules.

- **Ticks per point:** 10 ticks (0.10 per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $1.00
- **Cost per point:** $10.00
- **Cost / Contract Value:** 10 oz × Gold Price (e.g., at $2,500 = $25,000)

3. Cryptocurrency Futures

Bitcoin Futures - Standard (BTC)

Institutional-grade crypto instrument with large 5-Bitcoin sizing; highly volatile and capable of huge point moves, requiring substantial risk capital and wide cushions.

- **Ticks per point:** 0.2 ticks ($5.00 index move per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $25.00 (5 BTC × $5)
- **Cost per point:** $5.00 per $1.00 BTC move
- **Cost / Contract Value:** 5 BTC × Bitcoin Price (e.g., at $65,000 = $325,000)

Micro Bitcoin Futures (MBT)

Provides clean exposure to 24/7 crypto market sentiment and technical trendlines at a manageable 1/10th of a single Bitcoin per contract.

- **Ticks per point:** 0.2 ticks ($5.00 index move per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $0.50 (0.10 BTC × $5)
- **Cost per point:** $0.10 per $1.00 BTC move
- **Cost / Contract Value:** 0.10 BTC × Bitcoin Price (e.g., at $65,000 = $6,500)

Ether Futures - Standard (ETH)

Institutional contract representing 50 Ether; exhibits aggressive percentage intraday swings correlated with broader tech sentiment and altcoin cycles.

- **Ticks per point:** 2 ticks ($0.50 move per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $25.00 (50 ETH × $0.50)
- **Cost per point:** $50.00 per $1.00 ETH move
- **Cost / Contract Value:** 50 ETH × Ether Price (e.g., at $3,000 = $150,000)

Micro Ether Futures (MET)

Allows retail and combine traders to participate in Ethereum's high beta movements with minimal tick exposure (0.10 ETH contract size).

- **Ticks per point:** 2 ticks ($0.50 move per tick)
- **Cost per tick:** $0.05 (0.10 ETH × $0.50)
- **Cost per point:** $0.10 per $1.00 ETH move
- **Cost / Contract Value:** 0.10 ETH × Ether Price (e.g., at $3,000 = $300)

4. Quick Reference Specifications Matrix

Symbol	Contract Name	Tick Size	Ticks / Pt	Cost / Tick	Cost / Point	Multiplier / Sizing
ES	E-mini S&P 500	0.25	4	**$12.50**	**$50.00**	$50 × Index
MES	Micro E-mini S&P 500	0.25	4	**$1.25**	**$5.00**	$5 × Index
NQ	E-mini Nasdaq 100	0.25	4	**$5.00**	**$20.00**	$20 × Index
MNQ	Micro E-mini Nasdaq 100	0.25	4	**$0.50**	**$2.00**	$2 × Index
RTY	E-mini Russell	0.10	10	**$5.00**	**$50.00**	$50 × Index

Symbol	Contract Name	Tick Size	Ticks / Pt	Cost / Tick	Cost / Point	Multiplier / Sizing
	2000					
M2K	Micro E-mini Russell 2000	0.10	10	**$0.50**	**$5.00**	$5 × Index
YM	E-mini Dow Jones	1.00	1	**$5.00**	**$5.00**	$5 × Index
MYM	Micro E-mini Dow Jones	1.00	1	**$0.50**	**$0.50**	$0.50 × Index
NKD	Nikkei 225 (USD)	5.00	0.2	**$25.00**	**$5.00**	$5 × Index
MNK	Micro Nikkei 225 (USD)	5.00	0.2	**$2.50**	**$0.50**	$0.50 × Index
GC	Gold	0.10	10	**$10.00**	**$100.00**	100 oz × Price
MGC	Micro Gold	0.10	10	**$1.00**	**$10.00**	10 oz × Price
BTC	Bitcoin	$5.00	0.2	**$25.00**	**$5.00**	5 BTC ×

Symbol	Contract Name	Tick Size	Ticks / Pt	Cost / Tick	Cost / Point	Multiplier / Sizing
	(Standard)					Price
MBT	Micro Bitcoin	$5.00	0.2	**$0.50**	**$0.10**	0.10 BTC × Price
ETH	Ether (Standard)	$0.50	2	**$25.00**	**$50.00**	50 ETH × Price
MET	Micro Ether	$0.50	2	**$0.05**	**$0.10**	0.10 ETH × Price